

Notion Freelancer Dashboard: 5 Client + Project Templates

RenWork Digital Products

Introduction: Building Your Freelance Operating System

Welcome to the ultimate Notion setup for freelancers managing multiple clients. This guide provides

a step-by-step blueprint for creating five interconnected databases that transform chaotic project management into a streamlined, automated workflow. You will build a Client CRM, Project Tracker,

Invoice Log, Time Log, and Content Vault. By following these instructions, you will create a system

where data entered in one place automatically updates related views elsewhere, eliminating manual

data entry and ensuring you never miss a deadline or an invoice.

Template 1: Client CRM

Start by creating a new database titled "Clients." This is the central hub for all your client relationships. Add the following properties to this database:

1. **Name**: Title (Default).
2. **Status**: Select. Options: Lead, Active, Paused, Inactive.
3. **Tier**: Select. Options: Gold, Silver, Bronze.
4. **Contact Info**: Text. Include email and phone number.
5. **Rate**: Number. Format as Currency (\$). This is your hourly or daily rate for this specific client.
6. **Contract Signed**: Checkbox.
7. **Linked Projects**: Relation. Link to the "Projects" database (create this next if it doesn't exist).

Create three views for this database:

* **Board View (Pipeline)**: Group by "Status." This helps you visualize where each client sits in your sales or onboarding funnel.

* **Table View (Active Clients)**: Filter where "Status" is "Active." Sort by "Tier" descending.

* **Table View (All Clients)**: No filters. Sort by "Name."

Automation Idea: Create a template button inside the "Lead" status cards that pre-fills a welcome email draft and a contract checklist.

Template 2: Project Tracker

Create a new database titled "Projects." This database tracks specific engagements. Add these properties:

1. **Name**: Title.
2. **Client**: Relation. Link to the "Clients" database.
3. **Status**: Select. Options: Not Started, In Progress, Review, Completed, Canceled.
4. **Deadline**: Date.
5. **Deliverables**: Multi-select. Examples: Website, Logo, Copywriting, Setup.
6. **Invoiced**: Checkbox.
7. **Paid**: Checkbox.

Create the following views:

* **Kanban View (Active Projects)**: Group by "Status." Filter where "Status" is not "Completed" or "Canceled." This is your primary dashboard view.

* **Table View (Upcoming Deadlines)**: Filter where "Deadline" is within the next 7 days. Sort by "Deadline" ascending.

* **Board View (By Client)**: Group by "Client." This shows you exactly what is happening for each specific account.

Template 3: Invoice + Payment Log

Create a database titled "Invoices." This tracks all financial transactions. Properties include:

1. **Invoice #**: Formula or Manual Text. (e.g., INV-001).
2. **Client**: Relation. Link to "Clients."
3. **Project**: Relation. Link to "Projects."
4. **Amount**: Number. Currency format.

5. **Due Date**: Date.
6. **Status**: Select. Options: Draft, Sent, Paid, Overdue.
7. **Payment Date**: Date.

Views to create:

- * **Table View (Unpaid)**: Filter where "Status" is "Sent" or "Overdue." Sort by "Due Date."
- * **Table View (Monthly Income)**: Filter where "Status" is "Paid." Group by "Payment Date" (Month). Add a summary row at the bottom to sum the "Amount" column. This gives you your real-time monthly revenue.
- * **Gallery View (By Client)**: Group by "Client."

Template 4: Time Log

Create a database titled "Time Log." This is crucial for accurate invoicing and workload awareness.

Properties:

1. **Task**: Title.
2. **Project**: Relation. Link to "Projects."
3. **Start Time**: Date & Time.
4. **End Time**: Date & Time.
5. **Duration**: Formula. Calculate the difference between End and Start in hours.
6. **Billable**: Checkbox.

Views:

- * **Table View (Weekly Total)**: Filter where "Start Time" is within the last 7 days. Group by "Project." Sum the "Duration" column per group.
- * **Table View (Unbilled Hours)**: Filter where "Billable" is checked. This view should be reviewed before generating invoices to ensure you are charging for all work done.
- * **Calendar View (All Time)**: View all entries on a calendar to visualize your daily workload distribution.

Template 5: Content and Deliverable Vault

Create a database titled "Deliverables." This stores the actual files and assets. Properties:

1. **File Name**: Title.
2. **Type**: Select. Options: Design, Code, Document, Video, Audio.

3. **Project**: Relation. Link to "Projects."
4. **Status**: Select. Options: Draft, In Review, Approved, Delivered.
5. **Due Date**: Date.
6. **Version**: Number.
7. **File Link**: URL. (Link to Google Drive, Dropbox, or Notion file).

Views:

- * **Table View (Needs Review)**: Filter where "Status" is "In Review." Sort by "Due Date." This is your daily action list.
- * **Gallery View (By Project)**: Group by "Project." Use the "File Link" property to display thumbnails or icons.
- * **Table View (Delivered)**: Filter where "Status" is "Delivered." This serves as your portfolio archive.

Connecting The Databases with Relations and Rollups

The power of this system lies in the connections. Open the "Clients" database and ensure the "Linked Projects" relation is set up correctly. In the "Projects" database, the "Client" relation should automatically appear in the Clients database.

Next, add Rollups to make data visible where it matters.

1. **In Projects Database**: Add a Rollup property called "Total Invoiced." Link to the "Invoices" database, select the "Amount" property, and choose "Sum." This shows you exactly how much you have billed for a specific project instantly.
2. **In Clients Database**: Add a Rollup property called "Active Projects." Link to "Projects," select the "Name" property, and choose "Show original value." Then, add another Rollup called "Total Revenue." Link to "Invoices," select "Amount," and choose "Sum." This gives you a lifetime value metric for each client.
3. **In Deliverables Database**: Add a Rollup to the "Project" relation that pulls the "Status" from the Project database. This ensures that if a project is marked "Completed," you can filter your deliverables to see only those associated with finished work.

The Daily Workflow: Morning, Mid-Day, Shutdown

Use this routine to get maximum value from your dashboard.

****Morning Open (10 Minutes)****

1. Open the ****Project Tracker**** Kanban view. Scan the "In Progress" column. Identify the top priority task for the day.
2. Check the ****Deliverables**** "Needs Review" view. Are there any items due today that need your final approval or client feedback?
3. Glance at the ****Time Log**** Calendar view to see if you have any scheduled calls or fixed-time blocks.

****Mid-Day Check (5 Minutes)****

1. Open the ****Time Log****. Log your work session. Be specific with the "Task" title (e.g., "Homepage Hero Section Design" rather than "Work").
2. Check the ****Invoices**** "Unpaid" view. If any invoices are marked "Overdue," send a polite reminder email immediately. Do not let this sit.

****End-of-Day Shutdown (10 Minutes)****

1. Update the ****Time Log****. Ensure your "End Time" is recorded and "Billable" is checked if applicable.
2. Move completed tasks in the ****Deliverables**** database from "In Review" to "Approved" or "Delivered."
3. In the ****Project Tracker****, update the status of any projects that have hit a milestone. If a project is finished, mark it "Completed."
4. Review the ****Clients**** database. If you had a new lead, update their status in the Pipeline view.

By following this structure, you build a self-updating system that reduces cognitive load. You stop wondering what to do next; the dashboard tells you exactly where to focus, how much you have earned, and what needs your immediate attention. This is not just a tracker; it is your freelance business operating system.